Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip

Prof. Dr. Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip, CESE, LPT, MAED, MAELT, Ph.D. is one of the most distinguished academic leaders in the history of the Mindanao State University (MSU) System and a towering figure in Philippine teacher education.

A Full Professor and former Dean of the College of Education at MSU-Main Campus in Marawi City, she has spent more than four decades shaping how teachers are trained across the southern Philippines.

Her career is anchored in a simple but powerful belief: that education is the surest path to liberation, peace, and dignity for the Bangsamoro people.

In 2019, the Professional Regulation Commission (https://prc.gov.ph) (PRC) of the Philippines named her the Outstanding Professional of the Year in the field of Professional Teaching, making her widely recognized as the first Filipino Muslim to receive this honor, the most prestigious national distinction the PRC confers on a practicing professional.<ref name="prc2019">Professional Regulation Commission. (2019). *2019 Most Outstanding Professionals of the Year Awardees.* Retrieved from https://www.prc.gov.ph/2019-most-outstanding-professionals</ref>

Beyond her academic work, Dr. Sarip carries a traditional royal title: *Bae a Labi a Panoroganan ko Bayabao-Masiu*, a hereditary distinction that places her among the recognized leaders of Lanao's royal lineage.<ref name="prc2019" />

Her life story moves from a community schoolhouse in Taraka, Lanao del Sur, to the national stage in Manila, and eventually to international platforms in Thailand and the United States, all without losing the rootedness that defines her: a Maranao Muslim woman who chose to build, not leave.

Contents

1 Early Life and Cultural Roots
2 Education
3 Career
    3.1 Beginnings in Basic Education: MSU-Taraka Community High School
    3.2 Director, Office of Admissions, MSU-Main Campus
    3.3 Dean, College of Education, MSU-Main Campus
4 National and International Influence
    4.1 Philippine Association for Teacher Educators (PAFTE)
    4.2 Reading Association of the Philippines (RAP)
    4.3 Other National Affiliations
    4.4 International Recognition
5 Peace and Community Advocacy
6 The 2019 PRC Outstanding Professional Award
7 Awards and Recognition
8 Personal Life and Family
9 Legacy
10 See Also
11 Further Reading

Early Life and Cultural Roots

Dr. Sarip was born and raised in the heartland of the Maranao world, the lake province of Lanao del Sur in what was then the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM).

The exact date and municipality of her birth have not been publicly disclosed, but what's well-established is the cultural environment that shaped her: the world of the Maranao, one of the oldest and most artistically rich communities in the Philippines, a people whose identity is inseparable from the shores of Lake Lanao, the traditions of the sultanate, and the deep commitment to learning expressed through both Islamic scholarship and formal education.

She belongs to the broader world of Bangsamoro nobility.

Her royal title, *Bae a Labi a Panoroganan ko Bayabao-Masiu*, formally recognized by traditional authorities, places her within the aristocratic hierarchy of the Bayabao and Masiu domains, two of the historical royal houses of Lanao del Sur.<ref name="prc2019" />

This isn't simply a ceremonial distinction.

In Maranao society, a *bae* (or *bai*) is a female member of the royal class, and a *labi* is a title of further distinction within that class.

For Dr. Sarip, this identity has never been at odds with her scientific or professional pursuits; if anything, it has deepened them.

She has actively used her position as a traditional leader to facilitate conflict settlement and peace dialogues involving sultans, baes, and community professionals across the region.<ref name="prc2019" />

Her faith in Islam has also been central to her worldview.

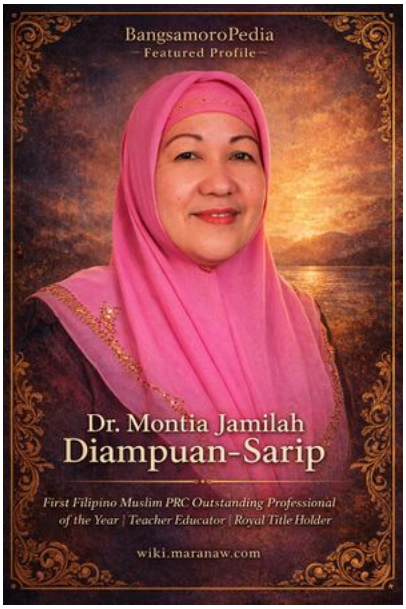
She approaches her work as an educator with a sense of calling rooted in the Islamic concept of *amanah* (stewardship) and the duty to pass on knowledge as an act of worship.

This blending of Maranao cultural pride, Islamic values, and professional rigor forms the distinctive philosophical foundation of everything Dr. Sarip has built.

Education

Dr. Sarip's academic credentials reflect a deliberate, layered investment in the discipline she would spend her life teaching: education itself.

Dr. Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip



Full Name	Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip
Credentials	CESE, LPT, MAED, MAELT, Ph.D.
Royal Title	*Bae a Labi a Panoroganan ko Bayabao-Masiu*
Nationality	Filipino
Religion	Islam
Spouse	Mr. Mohammad Harby B. Sarip, Sr. (retired international banker)
Children	7
Profession	Educator, Academic Administrator, Researcher
Institution	Mindanao State University (MSU-Main Campus), Marawi City
Rank	Full Professor
Former Posts	Dean, College of Education; Director, Office of Admissions; Principal, MSU-Taraka Community High School

She holds a Licensure for Professional Teaching (LPT), a Master of Arts in Education (MAED), and a Master of Arts in English Language Teaching (MAELT), along with a Ph.D. in Education, the terminal degree that qualified her for Full Professor rank at the Mindanao State University.<ref name="son">Sarip, J. D. (2025). *Personal communication regarding Prof. Dr. Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip.* [Family-provided biographical information from her son, Prof. Jamilnur D. Sarip].</ref>

National Recognition	2019 PRC Outstanding Professional of the Year (Professional Teacher)
Region	Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)

The MAELT in particular speaks to one of her core professional preoccupations: the quality of language instruction in Bangsamoro classrooms, where students often navigate multiple languages and where English proficiency has a direct bearing on board examination performance.

She is also a Career Executive Service Eligible (CESE), a distinction that recognizes her qualifications for the highest career executive positions in the Philippine civil service.<ref name="son" />

While the specific institutions and years of her graduate studies have not been publicly disclosed, the arc of her degrees tells its own story: a teacher who kept studying, kept deepening her expertise, and kept bringing that deeper knowledge back to the students and institution she served.

Her doctoral research took her to international forums.

She earned a Best Oral Presentation award at the 1st International Conference on Education held in Songkhla, Thailand in 2013, and has been nominated twice for inclusion in the *Who's Who in the World* directory published in New Jersey, United States.<ref name="prc2019">Professional Regulation Commission. (2019). *2019 Most Outstanding Professionals of the Year Awardees.* Retrieved from https://www.prc.gov.ph/2019-most-outstanding-professionals</ref>

Career

Beginnings in Basic Education: MSU-Taraka Community High School

Dr. Sarip's career didn't begin in the university halls of Marawi.

It began in the municipality of Taraka, where she served as Principal of the MSU-Taraka Community High School, a basic education institution operated under the Mindanao State University System.<ref name="source">Diampuan-Sarip, M. J. (n.d.). *Dr. Montia Jamilah Diampuan-Sarip: The Trailblazer of Bangsamoro Excellence* [Biographical document]. Provided source material.</ref>

This posting gave her early, direct experience with the challenges of educating young people in a community that is predominantly poor, predominantly rural, and often caught in the crossfire of the complex political landscape of Lanao del Sur.

As principal, she demonstrated that quality school leadership isn't only possible in well-resourced urban settings, but that it was urgently needed in places like Taraka, where many students come from farming families with limited access to academic support.

Her time there laid the groundwork for a leadership philosophy she would carry into every role that followed: every student, regardless of background, deserves the same standard of leadership and care.

Director, Office of Admissions, MSU-Main Campus

Before and alongside her deanship, Dr. Sarip also served as Director of the Office of Admissions at MSU-Main Campus in Marawi City.<ref name="source" />

In this role, she was responsible for upholding the university's admissions standards, a function that carries enormous weight in an institution like MSU, which serves as the primary gateway to higher education for thousands of young Bangsamoro people each year.

As admissions director, she maintained a commitment to meritocracy while navigating the realities of an institution serving students from some of the most economically disadvantaged communities in the Philippines.

Dean, College of Education, MSU-Main Campus

Dr. Sarip's most consequential institutional role was as Dean of the College of Education at MSU-Main Campus.

In this position, she held full professor rank and oversaw the implementation of curricula prescribed by the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), managing everything from faculty standards to research outputs to student performance on the national Licensure Examination for Teachers (LET).<ref name="prc2019" />

Under her deanship, the college achieved sustained improvement in LET performance, consistently producing topnotchers in the national board examinations.<ref name="source" />

This wasn't accidental.

She made curricular quality, faculty development, and student welfare simultaneous priorities, ensuring that the promise MSU made to Bangsamoro youth, that world-class education is possible in Marawi, was actually delivered.

Her administration also expanded scholarship access for students from government organizations (GOs) and non-government organizations (NGOs), prioritizing poor but deserving students who might otherwise have been shut out of higher education.<ref name="prc2019" />

She actively promoted paper presentations by both faculty and students at national and international conferences, building a research culture within the college that had broad ripple effects on MSU's national academic standing.<ref name="prc2019" />

She also pursued research collaboration with both GOs and NGOs, positioning the College of Education not just as a teaching unit but as an active contributor to Philippine educational policy.<ref name="prc2019" />

Her tenure lasted long enough to be remembered not by administrators or colleagues alone, but by the hundreds of licensed teachers she helped produce, many of whom are now educators across Mindanao and the broader Bangsamoro region.

National and International Influence

Philippine Association for Teacher Educators (PAFTE)

Dr. Sarip has been one of the most active Bangsamoro voices within the Philippine Association for Teacher Educators (PAFTE), the national organization that sets professional standards and shapes curriculum development for teacher education institutions across the Philippines.

She served as a National Board Member of PAFTE for two terms and led the PAFTE-ARMM Chapter as its Chairperson, giving the Bangsamoro region a strong institutional voice in national teacher education policy.<ref name="prc2019" />

In October 2018, PAFTE awarded her its highest distinction: the PAFTE Golden Award, in recognition of her exceptional contributions to teacher education in the Philippines.<ref name="prc2019" />

Reading Association of the Philippines (RAP)

One of Dr. Sarip's most historically significant contributions to national educational policy came through her work with the Reading Association of the Philippines (RAP), the country's foremost professional organization for reading educators and literacy advocates.

RAP is affiliated with the International Literacy Association (ILA), formerly the International Reading Association (IRA), which is based in the United States and serves as a global standard-setter for reading instruction and literacy programming.

Dr. Sarip served as a National Board Director of RAP for two terms, making her the first Muslim to sit on the national board of this organization, a landmark that brought inclusive representation for Mindanao and the Bangsamoro into national literacy policy discussions.<ref name="source" /><ref name="prc2019" />

She was also the Founding President of the RAP-Lanao Chapter, establishing for the first time a formal institutional home for reading advocacy within Lanao del Sur, a region where literacy challenges remain acute due to conflict displacement, poverty, and limited access to reading materials.<ref name="prc2019" />

Other National Affiliations

Beyond PAFTE and RAP, Dr. Sarip has served on the Board of Directors of the Muslim Congress of the Philippines and as a Member and Consultant to the RC-AKIC International College Foundation, Inc.<ref name="prc2019" />

She also served as Secretary to the MSU Royalties, the formal body that represents the traditional leadership of the MSU community, a role that bridges her academic and cultural identities.<ref name="prc2019" />

Following the 2017 Battle of Marawi, she was among the professionals consulted in designing the rehabilitation plan for the Most Affected Area, specifically contributing to the education sector components of Marawi's post-conflict reconstruction.<ref name="prc2019" />

International Recognition

Dr. Sarip's reach extends beyond Philippine shores.

She was nominated twice for and included in the *Who's Who in the World* publication based in New Jersey, USA, which profiles influential leaders across every significant field of endeavor worldwide.<ref name="prc2019" />

She has also been highlighted internationally for her work in promoting peace through education in conflict-affected regions, an achievement cited in connection with her nomination for an *Influential Educators of the World* citation from the United States.<ref name="source" />

Her Best Oral Presentation award at the 1st International Conference on Education in Songkhla, Thailand in 2013 further cemented her standing as a researcher and educator with international credibility.<ref name="prc2019" />

Peace and Community Advocacy

Dr. Sarip has never seen her role as purely academic.

She is a practicing peace advocate who draws on her royal title and community standing to bring warring parties to the table, often working alongside sultans, baes, and other community leaders to resolve disputes through dialogue.<ref name="prc2019" />

This work is especially significant given the decades-long armed conflict in Lanao del Sur and Marawi City.

In a region where trust in institutions has been tested repeatedly, traditional leaders like Dr. Sarip play a role that no government program can fully replicate: the ability to speak to community members in their own language, cultural framework, and emotional register.

She has also extended her community commitment to practical livelihood support, serving as a trainer for livelihood programs aimed at the wives of farmers, helping women in rural communities gain economic skills that improve household stability.<ref name="prc2019" />

This combination, academic scholarship plus grassroots community action, is what has made her legacy so durable.

The 2019 PRC Outstanding Professional Award

The single event that brought Dr. Sarip to national prominence outside Mindanao was her recognition at the 2019 Outstanding Professionals Awards Night, held on June 20, 2019, at the Fiesta Pavilion of the Manila Hotel, with then-Chief Justice Lucas Bersamin as the guest of honor.<ref name="prcnight">Professional Regulation Commission. (2019, June 28). *PRC 2019 Outstanding Professionals Awards Night.* Retrieved from https://www.prc.gov.ph/article/prc-2019-outstanding-professionals-awards-night/4000</ref>

She was named the Outstanding Professional of the Year in the category of Professional Teaching, the highest distinction the Professional Regulation Commission confers on a licensed teacher in the Philippines.

This recognition was historic on multiple levels.

She became widely recognized as the first professional from the MSU System to receive this national honor, validating the quality of instruction within MSU's campuses at the highest official level.<ref name="source" />

She was also recognized as the first educator from what is now the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) to reach this distinction, demonstrating that educators from the Bangsamoro can lead the entire Philippine professional landscape.<ref name="source" />

For the broader Filipino Muslim community, it was a moment of rare national affirmation, a public and official recognition that Muslim educators belong at the very top of the country's professional hierarchy.

The official PRC citation described her contribution to teaching as spanning 40 years, encompassing instruction, research, and extension services, all oriented toward academic excellence and alleviating poverty in the communities she serves.<ref name="prc2019" />

> "Dr. Sarip is a researcher awarded internationally; serves as resource person to local, national and international conferences; trainer for livelihood trainings to wives of farmers; involved in conflict settlement being a traditional leader who holds royal title as 'Bae a Labi a Panoroganan ko Bayabao Masiu'; and facilitate peace advocacy in the region with sultans, baes and professionals, shows her commitment and professionalism in her field."
> — Professional Regulation Commission, 2019 Citation<ref name="prc2019" />

Awards and Recognition

Dr. Sarip has received recognition at the barangay, municipal, regional, national, and international levels across a career spanning four decades.

Her confirmed honors include the following:

The **PRC Outstanding Professional of the Year in Professional Teaching** (2019), the highest national professional award in the Philippines, conferred by the Professional Regulation Commission at the 2019 Outstanding Professionals Awards Night in Manila.<ref name="prc2019" />

The **PAFTE Golden Award** (October 2018), given by the Philippine Association for Teacher Educators in recognition of her exceptional contributions to teacher education.<ref name="prc2019" />

The **Best Oral Presentation Award** at the 1st International Conference on Education in Songkhla, Thailand (2013), recognizing the quality of her research as presented before an international academic audience.<ref name="prc2019" />

Twice nominated for and included in **Who's Who in the World** (New Jersey, USA), which spotlights leaders making a global impact in their fields.<ref name="prc2019" />

Nominated for the **Influential Educators of the World** citation from the United States, recognizing her resilience in promoting peace through education in conflict-affected regions.<ref name="source" />

Personal Life and Family

Behind every milestone in Dr. Sarip's public career is a partnership and a household that made it possible.

She is married to Mr. Mohammad Harby B. Sarip, Sr., a retired international banker who spent his career with Al-Bank Al-Saudi Al-Fransi in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, one of the prominent banking institutions of the Arab world.<ref name="son" />

Their complementary worlds, his in international finance and hers in education, shaped a household where service, excellence, and professional commitment were simply part of daily life.

Together, they raised seven children, all of whom have built distinguished careers in government, law, education, medicine, and public service.<ref name="son" />

Princess Sittie Habibah D. Sarip-Paudac (LPT, MAED) is recognized as the first Muslim news anchor in the Philippines, having served under the Presidential Communications Operations Office (PCOO) at Malacañan.<ref name="son" />

Mohammad Harby D. Sarip, Jr., serves with the Ministry of Health under the BARMM.

Mohammad Hajam D. Sarip (CSE, MPA) holds an Assistant Regional Director-equivalent position at the Land Transportation Franchising and Regulatory Board (LTFRB) Region X.

Atty. Sittie Hadiya D. Sarip serves as a Prosecution Attorney at the Department of Justice (DOJ) under BARMM.

Precious Jawaher D. Sarip (LPT, MA, CAR) is a faculty member at MSU-Main Campus, continuing the family's tradition of teaching at the institution their mother helped build.

Dr. Mohammad Jamjoom D. Sarip (RN) is a medical professional and former secretary of the Integrated Provincial Health Office of Lanao del Sur.

The youngest, Prof. Jamilnur D. Sarip (LPT, DIS, MAIS, MPA, HC), currently serves as Director and former OIC Dean of MSU-General Santos, and has held positions as Regional Consultant at the Bangsamoro Sports Commission under BARMM and Project Manager for the Balay Mindanaw Foundation Inc. (BMFI) under projects of the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and Save the Children Philippines.<ref name="son" />

That seven children from one household hold professional positions spanning health, law, transportation regulation, presidential communications, higher education, and international development isn't coincidence.

It is the long harvest of what Dr. Sarip and her husband planted together: a family culture where doing meaningful work in service of the Bangsamoro was never optional, it was simply what you did.

Legacy

Forty years is a long time to do anything, but to sustain four decades of teaching with the same energy, idealism, and rigor that Dr. Sarip has is genuinely extraordinary.

What distinguishes her legacy isn't just the list of positions she held or the awards she collected, though both lists are impressive.

It's the texture of what she built: a College of Education that consistently sends out competent, licensed teachers into Bangsamoro classrooms; a RAP-Lanao Chapter that brought literacy advocacy to a region that desperately needs it; a PAFTE chapter that made sure the Bangsamoro's needs were heard in national teacher education policy; a peace advocacy practice rooted not in politics but in cultural authority and personal conviction; and a family that turned her values into a living, working inheritance spread across the institutions of this nation.

She made it clear, through the choices she made and the places she stayed, that a Maranao Muslim woman could be both a traditional leader and a national standard-setter, both a community elder and a globally recognized educator.

For the next generation of Bangsamoro professionals, especially young women from Lanao del Sur and across the region, that visibility matters enormously.

Dr. Sarip didn't just succeed.

She did it in a way that makes it easier for others to believe they can, too.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Marawi City
- Lanao del Sur
- Philippine Association for Teacher Educators
- Reading Association of the Philippines
- Professional Regulation Commission
- Battle of Marawi
- Maranao people

Further Reading

- Professional Regulation Commission. (2019). *2019 Most Outstanding Professionals of the Year Awardees.* https://www.prc.gov.ph/2019-most-outstanding-professionals
- Professional Regulation Commission. (2019, June 28). *PRC 2019 Outstanding Professionals Awards Night.* https://www.prc.gov.ph/article/prc-2019-outstanding-professionals-awards-night/4000
- Philippine Association for Teacher Educators (PAFTE). Official website and publications on the PAFTE Golden Award.
- Reading Association of the Philippines (RAP). *About RAP: Milestones on the Ruby Road to Literacy.* https://raporgph.wordpress.com/about/
- Mindanao State University System. *History.* https://www.msu.edu.ph/about-msu-history.php

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